Run PHP under FastCGI

By default, XAMPP runs PHP as an Apache handler. An alternative approach is to run PHP under FastCGI, which can produce better performance in certain scenarios. To do this, follow these steps:

1. Download a binary version of the *mod_fcgid* Apache module from the ApacheLounge website. This module is included in the *modules-2.4.x-win32-VC11.zip* archive.

   NOTE XAMPP for Windows only uses 32-bit Apache builds.

2. Extract the *mod_fcgid.so* file from the downloaded archive file and copy it to the *apache\modules* subdirectory of your XAMPP installation directory (usually, *C:\xampp*).

3. Edit the *httpd-xampp.conf* file in the *apache\conf\extra* subdirectory of your XAMPP installation directory. Within this file, make the following changes:

   a. Search for the line

   ```
   LoadModule php5_module "/xampp/php/php5apache2_4.dll"
   ```

   and modify it to read

   ```
   LoadModule fcgid_module modules/mod_fcgid.so
   ```

   b. Find and delete the following lines:

   ```
   <FilesMatch "\.php$">
     SetHandler application/x-httpd-php
   </FilesMatch>
   <FilesMatch "\.phps$">
     SetHandler application/x-httpd-php-source
   </FilesMatch>
   ```

   c. Add the following lines:

   ```
   FcgidInitialEnv PHPRC "c:/xampp/php"
   AddHandler fcgid-script .php
   FcgidWrapper "c:/xampp/php/php-cgi.exe" .php
   ```

   NOTE Remember to adjust the file and directory paths above to reflect valid paths on your system.

4. Restart your Apache server through the XAMPP control panel for your changes to take effect.

PHP should now be active using FastCGI. To verify this, browse to the URL http://localhost/xampp/phpinfo.php, which displays the output of the *phpinfo()* command, and check the "Server API" value near the top of the page.

PHP Version 5.5.15

System	Windows NT PLUTO 6.1 build 7601 (Windows 7 Business Edition Service Pack 1) i586
Build Date	Jul 23 2014 14:58:09
Compiler	MSVC11 (Visual C++ 2012)
Architecture	x86
Configure Command	cscript /nologo configure.js "--enable-snapshot-build" "--disable-isapi" "--enable-debug-pack" "--without-mssql" "--without-pdo-mssql" "--without-pi3web" "--with-pdo-oci=C:\php-sdk\oracle\x86\instantclient10\sdk,shared" "--with-oci8=C:\php-sdk\oracle\x86\instantclient10\sdk,shared" "--with-oci8-11g=C:\php-sdk\oracle\x86\instantclient11\sdk,shared" "--enable-object-out-dir=../obj/" "--enable-com-dotnet=shared" "--with-mcrypt=static" "--disable-static-analyze" "--with-pgo"
Server API	CGI/FastCGI
Virtual Directory Support	enabled
Configuration File (php.ini)	C:\Windows